

Hybrid Method

Visual blocking + structural correction

The hybrid method combines visual blocking (intuitive, gestural) with structural measuring (analytical, corrective). Use your eye to get close; use measurement to get it right. The best of both approaches.

KEY CONCEPTS

Block-In First

Start by visually blocking in the major shapes with confident, light marks. Don't measure at this stage — just respond to what you see. Get the big relationships: where the top is, where the bottom is, how wide vs. tall.

Measure to Correct

Once you have a rough block-in, switch to measuring. Check each measurement against your unit. Where are you off? Adjust the construction lines. Don't start rendering until the construction is accurate.

Iteration

The hybrid method is iterative: block → check → adjust → check → refine. Don't try to get it right in one pass. Each round of checking narrows the error. 3 rounds of checking will get you to 95% accuracy.

When to Use Which

Gesture and quick studies: mostly visual.
Portraits, figure drawings, technical illustrations: mostly measuring. Long-pose figure studies: hybrid throughout, with more measuring as you refine.

PRACTICE EXERCISES

1. Do a 20-minute portrait: first 5 min visual blocking, then 15 min of checking and refining.
2. Draw the same still life twice: once pure visual, once pure measuring. Compare.
3. Practice the 'check step': after each 5 minutes of drawing, pause and measure 3 things.

FURTHER READING

■ Proko – Sight-Size Method

<https://youtu.be/C8XGCeIJzXE>

■ New Masters Academy – Measuring